

Part 1 - Definition of the Problem

1. Size & Relevance

According to **INEGI and CONEVAL** income deciles (2024),

- Households earning between **MXN \$25,000 and \$80,000 per month** fall approximately in **deciles 7 to 9** — the **upper-middle 30%** of the income distribution.
- As of 2024, Mexico had about **36 million households** and **99 million people aged 18+** (INEGI).

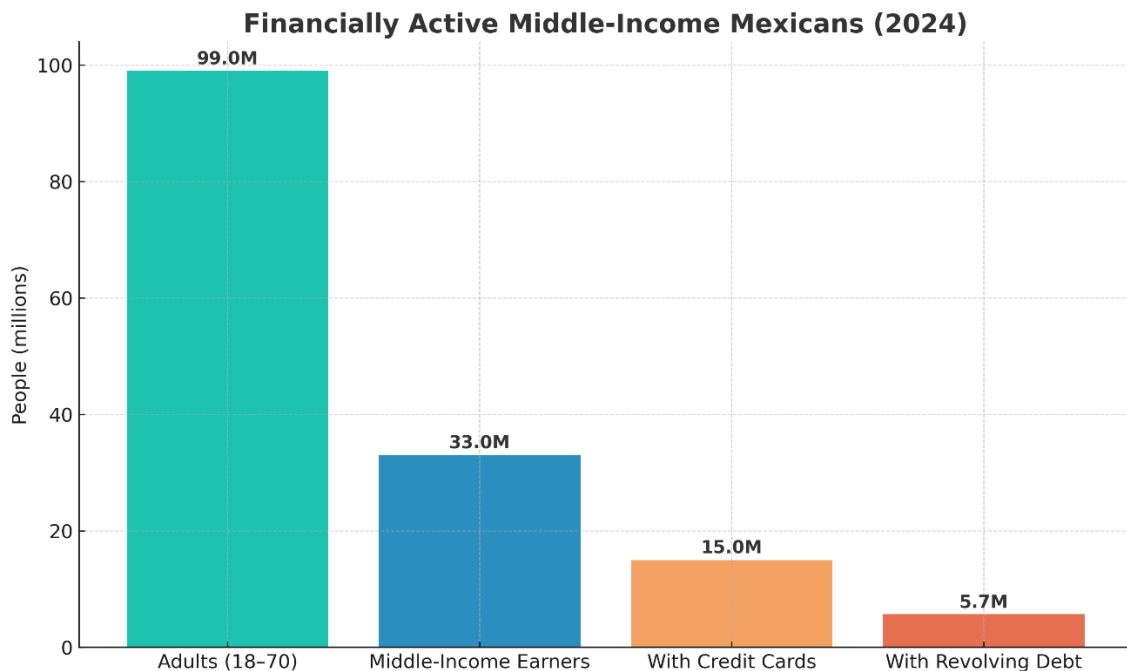
So, roughly:

Deciles 7–9 $\approx$ 30% of households $\approx$ 10.8 million households, representing around **33 million adults** who can be classified as *middle-income earners* under the income criteria defined.

From **ENIF 2024** (INEGI + CNBV):

- 45.9%** of adults in the *middle-income bracket* (deciles 7–9) report **owning at least one credit card**.
- 38%** of those cardholders carry **revolving debt** (i.e., they do not pay their full balance monthly).

Therefore, about **5–6 million formally employed, middle-income adults** in Mexico are currently **carrying credit card debt month to month**.



Sources: ENIF 2024 (INEGI & CNBV); Banxico; CONEVAL Income Deciles (2024). Estimates based on adults aged 18–70.
Approximate addressable population: 5–6 million middle-income adults with revolving credit card debt.

Additional to the segment with financial stress from revolving debt, there is also a group with suboptimal budget utilization:

From **CNBV/ENIF 2024**:

- **Only 3 in 10 middle-income adults save consistently.**
- **Fewer than 12% invest beyond CETES or simple savings accounts.**

This means that **the majority (~70%) of the financially active adults are not managing money optimally**, even if they're not in visible debt distress.

Tío Richie targets a financially literate but behaviorally struggling segment: 15 million reachable Mexicans, of whom at least two-thirds demonstrate inconsistent saving, debt reliance, or short-term financial thinking.

Market Layer	Size (approx.)	Description
Total Addressable Market (TAM)	33M adults	All middle-income Mexicans (MXN 25k–80k/month).
Serviceable Addressable Market (SAM)	15M adults	Formally employed, banked, digitally active.
Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM)	10M adults	Those with revolving debt and short-term financial thinking.

2. Urgency

As interest rates rise, many middle-income Mexicans are **using credit cards to sustain lifestyle expenses**, accumulating high-interest debt. This demographic is at risk of **financial burnout**, where steady income no longer translates to progress or security.

- Inflation has **eroded purchasing power by over 17% since 2020** (Banxico, 2024), while consumer credit has expanded at **12–14% annual growth** (BBVA Research, 2025).

Without intervention, they'll face **retirement vulnerability** and a **shrinking middle class**, two of Mexico's most alarming socioeconomic trends:

- Only 39.2% of working-age adults hold a formal retirement/AFORE account.
- Of those, mere ~3% actively cite retirement as purpose of contribution.
- Contribution rate is low (~6.5% of salary), leading to underfunded retirement payouts.
- Just ~26% of people over 60 receive a retirement pension. Many will age with no steady income.
- Mexico devotes only ~3.6% of GDP to public pensions, far below OECD norms, limiting safety nets.

3. Frequency

Frequency	Typical Triggers	Behavioral Outcome
Daily	Purchases, balance checks, credit card notifications, BNPL reminders	Small but constant stress: "Can I afford this?" "Did I overspend?"
Weekly	Bill payments (utilities, subscriptions), grocery runs, credit alerts	Perceived loss of control; "I just got paid and it's gone."
Biweekly	Payroll deposits (quincena), credit card cut-offs	Emotional swings: excitement → guilt → resignation.
Monthly	Loan payments, savings contributions, credit statements	Reflection and guilt: "I swear next month I'll be smarter."

They experience **5–10 “micro-decisions” about money every single day**, each reinforcing the feeling that they can’t get ahead. That’s 3,000+ reinforcement loops a year.

Frequency isn’t just about actions; it’s about **emotional recurrence**. This problem keeps users mentally occupied because money touches every aspect of daily life.

- **Morning:** checks BBVA app, sees card balance, immediate anxiety.
- **Afternoon:** spends impulsively on lunch or delivery, rationalizes: “I deserve it.”
- **Evening:** reminder of credit payment; guilt or avoidance.
- **Weekend:** overspends on leisure or family commitments → regret on Sunday night.

Average middle-income Mexican checks their banking app **3–5 times a day** (BBVA internal data, 2024).

The user’s digital life keeps them *financially aware but behaviourally lost*.

- **Bank app usage:** 80% of banked adults log in **daily or every few days** (ENIF 2024).
- **Digital purchases:** 7 of 10 use debit or credit cards for recurring payments (utilities, streaming, phone).
- **Notifications:** Credit cards, fintechs, and banks send an average of **8–12 finance-related alerts per week**.
- **Financial exposure on social media:** Constant aspirational comparison on TikTok, Instagram, and influencers (“This is how I travel more, save more, spend better”).

Each of these touchpoints reinforces **financial self-awareness** but **not financial literacy**. Users constantly see their data but don’t *understand* it.

Mexico’s salary cycle itself guarantees frequency of stress and repetition.

- **Paid twice a month (quincenal)** → mini-boom and bust every 15 days.
- Between paydays, most users **run out of cash by day 9–10** (CONDUSEF 2023).
- They often turn to credit cards or BNPL to bridge the gap, restarting the same loop.

In behavioural economics terms, this is a **predictable cycle of scarcity and relief**, happening **24 times a year** per worker.

4. Cost

"How much money do people lose each year because they don't manage finances better?"

Households in this segment lose **10–15% of their income annually** in unnecessary interest, late fees, and impulsive spending (Banxico, BBVA 2023).

Type of Cost	Average Amount / Rate	Annual Cost for Target User
Credit card interest	40–60 % annual interest rate (Banxico, 2024)	MXN \$18,000–\$25,000 per year for a typical balance of MXN \$40–50k revolving monthly
Late fees / missed payments	MXN \$300–\$500 per incident	MXN \$3,000–\$5,000 per year (1 missed per month typical)
Impulse purchases & unplanned spending	5–8 % of income (CONDUSEF study on consumption drivers)	MXN \$15,000–\$25,000 per year
Total behavioral leakage	—	MXN \$30,000–\$55,000 annually per household

Beyond losses, there's the *wealth never created* because savings stay idle or vanish.

- Only **12 %** of middle-income adults invest beyond CETES or simple savings (ENIF 2024).
- Average CETES or savings account yields: **6–9 %** annual.
- Average long-term market return (balanced global ETF or AFORE SIEFORE): **10–12 %** annual.

If a 30-year-old invests **MXN \$3,000/month**, the 30-year difference between 7 % and 11 % returns is **~MXN 1.7 million**.
That's the cost of staying "safe but stagnant."

By avoiding investment entirely, this generation gives up the equivalent of a small home or 10 years of retirement income.

Mexico's retirement structure magnifies the cost of inaction.

Indicator	Data	Source
Workers with active AFORE account	39.2 % of adults 18–70	ENIF 2024 / México Como Vamos
Average contribution rate	6.5 % of salary	MAPFRE / CNBV
Expected replacement rate (income in retirement vs. working income)	26–30 %	OECD Pensions at a Glance 2023
Adults 60+ receiving pension income	26 %	Aging in Mexico, PMC
Estimated additional savings needed for decent retirement (private supplement)	MXN 3–4 million per worker	Banxico & CONSAR projections

Meaning:

- Even consistent AFORE contributors will retire on **1/4 of their salary**.
- Those without regular savings will depend on family or informal work at age 65+.
- For a middle-income household, failing to invest today equals **tens of millions of pesos in lost lifetime security**.

5. Necessity

Mexico's middle class isn't uninformed, it's **behaviorally misaligned**.

- ENIF 2024 shows that **77% of adults believe they are "good at managing money,"** yet only **31% actively save** and fewer than **12% invest**.
- The **issue isn't awareness. It's execution**. People know what to do ("save more, spend less"), but lack systems that help them follow through.

This gap is amplified by:

- **Instant gratification culture**: short-term pleasure outweighs long-term security.
- **Stress-driven decisions**: money choices made under emotional pressure.
- **Absence of behavioural feedback loops**: nothing in their daily financial life nudges them toward consistency.

Mexico has an expanding landscape of financial content, but most of it fails your audience:

- **Too technical** (financial literacy programs speak in jargon, not habits).
- **Too moralizing** ("stop buying coffee" messages that alienate users).
- **Too scattered** (influencers and banks offer isolated tips, not a cohesive system).

Meanwhile:

- CONDUSEF reports that **66% of adults have never received formal financial education.**
- Financial guidance online is **overwhelming**, fragmented, and often contradictory.
- There is **no trusted, behaviourally adaptive system** that helps users move from *knowing* to *doing*, step by step.

Without structured behavioral intervention, users are trapped in a **permanent learning loop** that never converts into change:

1. Payday relief ("Ahora sí, este mes me organizo").
2. Mid-month overextension ("Bueno, sólo uso la tarjeta").
3. Month-end stress ("¿Por qué no me alcanza?").
4. Emotional reset ("El próximo mes será diferente").

This cycle repeats **24 times per year** (quincenas) and **feeds avoidance** rather than accountability.

They don't need more information. They need a system that can interrupt this cycle through micro-wins, challenges, and automatic habit scaffolding.

Part 2 – Define your target customer

Persona 1 — Daniela Torres, “The Overextended Achiever”

Attribute	Description
Age / Demographics	34 years old, lives in Querétaro with her partner, no children yet. Holds a bachelor’s degree in marketing and works as a sales executive for a national retail brand.
Income / Economic context	MXN 45,000 monthly salary (with bonuses). Rents a two-bedroom apartment, owns a car. Uses payroll and two credit cards (BBVA, Santander).
Interests	Fitness, weekend trips, fashion, home décor. Follows financial-wellness influencers on TikTok but doesn’t apply their advice consistently.
Behavioural traits	Disciplined at work but impulsive with money. Checks her banking app daily, yet avoids reviewing credit balances until payment is due. Feels guilty after overspending.
Goals	1. Pay off credit card debt within the next year. 2. Start saving for a home down payment. 3. Feel “in control” of her finances without giving up her lifestyle.
Pain points	• Revolving credit-card debt and high interest (45 – 60 %). • Constant mid-month cash shortages (“quincena syndrome”). • Anxiety and guilt tied to spending. • No clear plan for long-term savings or retirement.
Buying patterns / channels	Heavy smartphone user. Discovers new apps through Instagram, TikTok, and friends’ recommendations. Prefers tools that are visual, gamified, and emotionally supportive rather than technical. Would try a free tier quickly if guided by short-form content or testimonials.

Why she’s an early adopter:

She already tracks her finances superficially, wants change, and is comfortable with fintech. She’ll adopt *Tío Richie* if it feels *empathetic, smart, and judgment-free*, helping her turn intention into daily action.

Persona 2 — Alejandro Ruiz, “The Responsible Provider”

Attribute	Description
Age / Demographics	42 years old, lives in Monterrey with his wife and two children (ages 8 and 11). Industrial engineer working in manufacturing management.
Income / Economic context	Household income $\approx$ MXN 75,000/month (his salary + partner’s part-time income). Pays mortgage and car loan; uses payroll account plus two credit cards.
Interests	Family well-being, long-term security, tech gadgets, personal development podcasts.
Behavioural traits	Rational, analytical, but avoids financial complexity. Keeps spreadsheets but rarely updates them. Stressed about future expenses (kids’ education, retirement).
Goals	1. Build an emergency fund and college savings plan. 2. Reduce dependency on credit cards. 3. Begin investing beyond AFORE or CETES.
Pain points	• High monthly debt repayments eating 30 % of income. • Lack of integrated visibility of household cash flow. • Uncertainty about retirement adequacy. • Overwhelmed by financial jargon; wants simplicity.
Buying patterns / channels	Consumes professional content on LinkedIn, YouTube, and tech media. Responds to credibility and data-driven narratives more than emotion. Prefers desktop for setup, mobile for daily check-ins. Would pay for premium features once proven useful.

Why he’s an early adopter:

He’s financially literate but time-poor, needs automation and clarity, not lectures. *Tío Richie* appeals because it translates financial complexity into practical, goal-based coaching he can trust.

Appendix 1: Key Sources & Data

Topic	Source / Link	Key Findings / Relevant Excerpts
Financial Inclusion in Mexico (2024)	INEGI – <i>Encuesta Nacional de Inclusión Financiera (ENIF) 2024</i> https://en.www.inegi.org.mx/programas/enif/2024/	63% of adults (18–70) have at least one formal financial product (savings, credit, insurance, or Afore). 45.9% of middle-income earners have credit cards, and 38% carry revolving debt.
Formal vs. Informal Savings	CNBV & INEGI – ENIF 2024 Press Release https://www.gob.mx/cnbv/es/articulos/cnbv-y-el-inegi-presentan-los-resultados-de-la-encuesta-nacional-de-inclusion-financiera-2024	Only 3 in 10 adults save consistently. Formal saving (bank or Afore) remains below 30%, while informal methods (cash, tandas) dominate.
Financial Health and Stress	INEGI – <i>Encuesta Nacional sobre Salud Financiera (ENSAFI) 2023</i> https://www.inegi.org.mx/contenidos/salade prensa/boletines/2024/ENSAFI/ENSAFI.pdf	52% of adults reported having some savings, but only 10% could cover three months of income. 48% live under financial stress due to debt or lack of savings.
Credit Usage & Growth	BBVA Research – <i>Situación Banca México, March 2025</i> https://www.bbvaresearch.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/03/Situacion-Banca-Mexico-Marzo-2025.pdf	Consumer credit grew 12.7% in real terms in 2024. 46% of total household credit is tied to consumption and housing.
Expansion of Card Ownership	BBVA Research – <i>Mexico: Debit and Credit Card Contracts Growth Report (2024)</i> https://www.bbvaresearch.com/en/publicaciones/mexico-from-june-to-august-2024-debit-and-credit-card-contracts-grow-by-04-million/	Debit and credit card contracts increased by 0.4 million between June and August 2024 — evidence of credit expansion among the middle class.
Inflation & Erosion of Purchasing Power	Banco de México (Banxico) – <i>Sistema de Información Económica (SIE)</i> https://www.banxico.org.mx/SieInternet/	Cumulative inflation (2020–2024) exceeds 17%. Real wages have stagnated, reducing household purchasing power despite stable employment levels.
Household Debt to GDP	Trading Economics – <i>Mexico Household Debt to GDP</i> https://tradingeconomics.com/mexico/holds-debt-to-gdp	Household debt represents ~16.7% of GDP (2024), with credit card debt as one of the fastest-growing components.
Consumer Debt Levels	CEIC Data – <i>Mexico Household Debt (in USD)</i> https://www.ceicdata.com/en/indicator/mexico/household-debt	Household debt has increased steadily since 2021, reaching USD 183 billion in 2024.
Macro Financial Stability	Banco de México – <i>Financial Stability Report 2024</i> https://www.banxico.org.mx/publicaciones-and-press/financial-system-reports/%7B1DDCC744-D56B-0BA1-584B-52DAADCA217E%7D.pdf	Identifies rising household indebtedness and risk exposure in consumption credit as one of the main threats to Mexico's middle-class stability.
Digital Banking & Financial Behavior	<i>El País México</i> (2025) – “Cada vez más mexicanos usan la banca por su celular” https://elpais.com/mexico/2025-03-14/cada-vez-mas-mexicanos-usan-la-banca-por-su-celular-y-menos-el-dinero-en-efectivo.html	76.5% of adults now use digital banking or mobile apps for financial transactions. However, financial literacy remains low despite digital adoption.

Appendix 2: Key Data Points on Pension / Retirement in Mexico

Finding	Source	Implication for Target Segment
Only 39.2% of people aged 18–70 have a retirement savings account / AFORE (retirement account) in Mexico	"Mexico, how are we doing in retirement savings?" (Mexico Como Vamos) (mexicocomovamos.mx)	Suggests that 60%+ of working-age adults do not even hold a formal instrument for retirement. Among our target (middle-income, formal sector), the subset saving for retirement is likely even smaller.
In 2021, 39.1% of 18–70 had a retirement or AFORE account; only ~3% of savers cited retirement as their motivation	BBVA Research – "Retirement savings and pension culture in Mexico" (BBVA Research)	Even when people hold retirement instruments, very few use them <i>actively</i> for long-term goals. Many hold the accounts passively without contribution discipline.
Mexico's contribution rate for pension accounts is very low (~6.5% of salary)	MAPFRE / pension commentary (MAPFRE)	Low contribution rates can lead to inadequate balances at retirement. Even for those who do contribute, the baseline is often too meager to generate sufficient lifetime income.
Low pension coverage for older adults: only ~26.1% of people 60+ receive retirement pensions	"Aging in Mexico" (PMC) (PMC)	Suggests many older adults will enter retirement with no income safety net, a systemic problem.
Mexico currently spends ~3.6% of GDP on public pensions (less than OECD average of ~7.7%)	IMF / pension reform assessment (IMF eLibrary)	Indicates limited state capacity to subsidize retirement; the burden falls more on individuals.